

Go to work, go home

Teaching guide

Describe destinations with the right phrase.

Understand the distinction

Use go to before many destinations: go to the station, go to Osaka. Common activity expressions such as go to work and go to school usually omit the article when you mean the usual activity.

Home, here, there, upstairs, and abroad can work as destination adverbs: go home, go there. Do not add to in these patterns. Go to the school can mean visiting a particular school building.

Compare the patterns

DESTINATION

We are going to the station.

Use to with the place noun.

HOME

I am going home.

Home needs no to here.

ACTIVITY

She goes to work by bus.

The expression names the daily activity.

Read each example. Explain what the highlighted choice means in context. Then cover the example and say a similar sentence.

Check your understanding

Write before looking at the answers. The guide gives a model answer and explains the choice. Other wording can be correct.

1. I am tired. I want to go ____ . (home / to home)

2. Add the missing word: We went ____ the museum.

3. Does go to the school always mean attend classes?

Use it in your own life

Describe two places you go on a normal day.

Self-check

Does your sentence express your intended meaning? Does its form follow the relevant pattern? Can a reader understand the context?

Try again

After checking the explanation, revise your sentence. Say it aloud or use it in a short conversation.

Answers and explanation

1. home

Home is a destination adverb here.

2. to

Museum is a noun naming a destination.

3. No. It can mean visit the school building.

The article can highlight a particular place rather than the routine activity.

One possible response

I go to work at eight. I go home at five.

This is a model, not the only acceptable answer. Assess meaning, grammar, and context together.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-02.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Ask learners to explain the differences between the comparison examples before reading the rules. Use their answers to identify the point that needs attention.

2. Explain and check (4 minutes)

Read the short explanation together. Keep its qualifications: a common pattern is not necessarily a rule for every context. Ask learners to give a counterexample where the lesson mentions an exception.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Describe two places you go on a normal day.

Have learners work alone, then compare with a partner. Ask the partner to restate the intended meaning before suggesting a correction.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Use the answer explanations to review the three checks. Accept natural alternatives that preserve the intended meaning. Ask each learner to revise one sentence and identify the change.

Extension

Change the person, time, place, or purpose in a comparison example. Ask whether the original pattern still fits and why. Revisit one example in the next lesson.

Feedback criteria

Meaning: the message is understandable. Form: the target pattern fits the context. Transfer: the learner can use it in a fresh example. This short activity is not a proficiency certification.